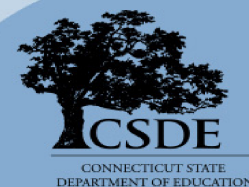


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2022-23



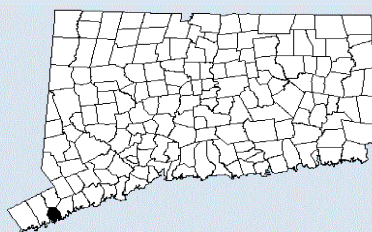
Darien School District

Dr. Alan Addley, Superintendent • 203-656-7400 • <http://www.darienps.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	7
Enrollment	4,700
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$23,555
Total Expenditures ¹	\$112,215,312

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2021-22 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2022-23 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2022 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.4
Male	2,404	51.1	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	293	6.2	5.2
Black or African American	31	0.7	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	333	7.1	30.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	215	4.6	4.5
White	3,823	81.3	47.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	62	1.3	9.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	62	1.3	42.4
Students with Disabilities ³	882	18.8	17.1

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	101	4.5	7	0.3
Male	105	4.5	62	2.5
Non-Binary	0	*	0	*
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	22	6.8	9	2.6
White	162	4.3	55	1.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	0	0.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*	*	*
Students with Disabilities	64	6.8	20	1.9
District	206	4.5	69	1.4
State		20.0		7

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 64

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Darien School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	348.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	19.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	72.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	112.4
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	10.6
School Level	31.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	9.0
Support Staff	5.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	22.2
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	33.0
School Nurses	13.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	191.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	7	1.3	1.3
Black or African American	9	1.7	4.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	13	2.5	4.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	1	0.2	0.2
White	501	94.4	88.7

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2021-22

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	11.1	13.2

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	0	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	26	100.0	26	100.0
White	272	97.8	288	98.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	8	*	12	*
Students with Disabilities	78	96.3	81	97.6
District	325	97.9	344	98.3
State		86.5		94.2

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	30	46.2
Emotional Disability	*	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	195	76.5
Other Health Impairment	215	77.6
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	104	80.0
District	572	72.2
State		68.6

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Darien School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	69	1.5	2.4
Emotional Disability	39	0.8	1.0
Intellectual Disability	11	0.2	0.6
Learning Disability	255	5.5	6.3
Other Health Impairment	279	6.0	3.4
Other Disabilities	28	0.6	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	149	3.2	1.9
All Disabilities	830	18.0	16.7

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.1
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.7

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2021-22

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$65,822,458	\$13,817	\$12,671
Support services - students	\$10,636,692	\$2,251	\$1,558
Support services - instruction	\$5,256,768	\$1,113	\$837
Support services - general administration	\$1,735,130	\$367	\$463
Support services - school based administration	\$7,424,805	\$1,571	\$1,133
Central and other support services	\$4,426,962	\$937	\$716
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$10,496,108	\$2,221	\$1,893
Student transportation services	\$4,339,909	\$2,172	\$1,464
Food services	.	.	\$5
Enterprise operations	\$2,076,480	\$439	\$186
Total	\$112,215,312	\$23,555	\$20,165

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2021-22

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$6,528,495	18.9	29.0
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$4,224,342	12.2	10.6
Other Salaries	\$7,064,535	20.4	10.1
Employee Benefits	\$4,313,978	12.5	13.1
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$4,115,291	11.9	5.9
Special Education Tuition	\$6,691,882	19.4	21.8
Supplies	\$164,806	0.5	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,293,410	3.7	8.1
Equipment	\$172,034	0.5	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$670	0.0	0.1
Total	\$34,569,444	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		30.8	24.9

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2021-22

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	94.7
State	3.0
Federal	1.8
Tuition & Other	0.6

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Darien School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Asian	149	88.4	149	91.9	69	86.2
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	158	77.0	157	75.9	77	74.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	115	84.3	115	87.2	34	84.9
White	1,963	79.9	1,962	80.1	824	76.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	60	71.7	60	73.0	24	58.2
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	2,340	80.6	2,337	80.9	986	77.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	34	65.7	34	66.6	21	66.2
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,366	80.6	2,363	81.0	989	77.6
Students with Disabilities	484	63.7	483	62.9	196	59.2
Students without Disabilities	1,916	84.6	1,914	85.2	814	81.7
High Needs	545	65.2	544	64.8	220	60.9
Non-High Needs	1,855	84.8	1,853	85.4	790	82.0
District	2,400	80.4	2,397	80.7	1,010	77.4

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	81.1	89.4	88.9	89.8	1,286	87.2
Curl Up	91.3	96.7	97.3	96.5	1,261	95.4
Push Up	95.2	90.1	93.9	91.3	1,286	92.7
Mile Run/PACER	89.0	86.7	87.4	81.4	1,104	86.2
All Tests - District	65.7	74.5	72.8	71.6	1,052	71.9
All Tests - State	51.5	46.0	44.1	41.1		45.5

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Darien School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2021-22	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	7	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	13	*
White	316	98.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	16	*
Students with Disabilities	88	92.0
District	359	98.1
State		88.9

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2021-22 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	98.3	295	84.5
Male	98.8	262	78.7
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	100.0	33	63.5
White	98.2	470	82.5
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	95.5	14	63.6
Students with Disabilities	96.3	77	47.0
District	98.5	557	81.7
State	95.2		44.3

³ Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴ Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2023 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2022	Class of 2021
	Entrance ⁵	Persistence ⁶
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	86.5	97.7
Male	90.1	95.4
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	88.4	97.3
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	84.1	89.5
District	88.4	96.5
State	66.1	87.7

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Darien School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	80.4	75	50.0	50	100.0	63.9
	High Needs Students	65.2	75	43.5	50	87.0	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	80.7	75	50.0	50	100.0	59.7
	High Needs Students	64.8	75	43.2	50	86.4	48.9
Science Performance Index	All Students	77.4	75	50.0	50	100.0	61.6
	High Needs Students	60.9	75	40.6	50	81.1	51.1
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	65.1%	100%	65.1	100	65.1	57.2%
	High Needs Students	55.7%	100%	55.7	100	55.7	52.5%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	78.1%	100%	78.1	100	78.1	61.8%
	High Needs Students	68.6%	100%	68.6	100	68.6	55.5%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	70.3%	100%	35.2	50	70.3	55.3%
	Oral	77.2%	100%	38.6	50	77.2	56.1%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	4.5%	<=5%	50.0	50	100.0	20.0%
	High Needs Students	6.4%	<=5%	47.3	50	94.6	28.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	98.1%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	90.4%
	% Meeting Benchmark	81.7%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		97.0%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	82.4%
4-year Graduation All Students (2022 Cohort)		98.1%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.9%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2020 Cohort)		96.6%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	85.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2022)		88.4%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		73.5% 71.9%	75%	24.0	50	47.9	93.0% 45.5%
Arts Access		63.8%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	54.5%
Accountability Index				1239.7	1450	85.5	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	65.2	9.8	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	64.8	10.2	18.0	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	60.9	14.1	17.8	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	96.6%	0.0%	8.7%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.8
	High Needs Students	97.4
Math	All Students	98.7
	High Needs Students	97.2
Science	All Students	98.4
	High Needs Students	95.3

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 65.8

State: 49.6

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Darien School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Continuous improvement is a hallmark of the Darien Public Schools. District goals and improvement plans support building a culture of professional learning and collaboration as strategic planning efforts operationalize the District mission, vision and core values and goals. The recently adopted Vision of the Graduate will also guide the District's work in the years ahead.

Professional learning is at the heart of District improvement efforts. Whether working in teams, collaborating with Teachers College or engaging in other forms of job-embedded professional development, the talented faculty demonstrate high-quality instruction and commitment to learning. The District focuses on utilizing instructional technology to enhance learning for students.

Darien prioritizes and practices the advancement of learner-centered practices to engage students and improve learning. With a continuous commitment to providing quality PK-12 supports and interventions, teachers and specialists work together to provide dynamic differentiated instruction grounded in student performance data. Additionally, the District values co-teaching as an instructional model to support populations of special learners.

Darien is known for providing an excellent and dynamic curriculum as the foundation to an exceptional learning experience. Therefore, curriculum revision is continuous and responsive, ensuring teachers are current and students have access to guaranteed and viable programs of study. Commitment to curriculum represents reflective practice and commitment to high-quality pedagogy and assessment.

Communication and outreach with families plays an important role in District processes. In addition to an updated website, systems for messaging and regular public meetings, the District benefits from an impressive parent network that supports student learning at both the school and District levels. Parents lend their talents and resources to the schools and are included in the decision making process. The District also works closely with many town organizations to support the needs of families and students to support engagement in school and their social and emotional health. The District strives to continuously improve systems for communication with parents and the community so that everyone has a clear picture of the district philosophy and programs. Decisions are made in the best interests of all students.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

In order to address racial, ethnic, and economic isolation, Darien works with strategic partners to optimize conditions for the learning community. Collaborating with various organizations allows for ongoing professional learning for staff, essential education for students and strategies to make systemic improvements for equity and access.

The District engages in a variety of experiences for students across diverse communities. Recent opportunities for students include participation in The Center for Global Study Interdistrict Magnet Program, the Regional Center for the Arts Magnet; The Westhill Vocational Agriculture Program; the Stamford Academy of IT & Engineering; the Western Region CMEA HS Music Festival; FCIAC HS competitions; and CSDE Interdistrict Music Programs.

Additionally, students interact with peers across communities through school-sponsored clubs and activities including debate team; DECA; robotics club; Ultimate Frisbee; JETS, math team; Model Congress; and Model UN. Participation in the A Better Chance Program; Respect for Differences; Building with Books; Person-to-Person; the Anti-Defamation League's NAMES Program; and the China Youth Exchange. Darien's comprehensive athletic and arts programs foster opportunities for peer relationships beyond Darien. Students from other communities reside in Darien and go to the District schools through participation in the ABC Program. provide additional learning opportunities for students.

Through student-led organizations, like student council and government, students connect with local agencies to support social initiatives for children & their families in neighboring towns. Across grade levels and content areas, students experience learning to raise their social awareness and understanding of diverse perspectives. As curriculum is revised, Darien continues to build an understanding of diversity as a reflection of society and the ever-changing world.

Efforts to celebrate diversity and reduce racial and ethnic isolation have been identified as priorities for consideration of inclusion in the development of the District's strategic plan. In alignment with these efforts, the District will enter year two with A Diversity, Equity and Inclusion Team working to support and guide District efforts.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Darien School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The District recognizes the need to provide an equitable education for all students. Darien develops and supports policies and practices that ensure access to resources at all buildings. The annual budget appropriates funding for programming supporting comprehensive and inclusive offerings that are aligned to a rigorous curriculum. Funding formulas ensure equity in budgeting among the five elementary schools. The District takes great pride in the quality of instruction and access to learning for all students.

Darien adheres to class size guidelines and ensures resources, materials, and high-quality educators are in place with consistency. Initiatives are identified through system-wide planning and curriculum evaluation processes that are communicated to all stakeholders. District data teams support the work of understanding the varying needs of the student population and make data informed decisions.

Additionally, Darien benefits from the generosity of PTOs and many community organizations and businesses. Parents have positively contributed to the District's Strategic Plan, Vision of the Graduate, budget process, gifts, and recognition of students' accomplishments.